**VP OF OPERATIONS**

## GENERAL INFO

PB Technologies is a moderate-sized, publicly traded company. Its specialty is addressing other companies' technological and integration problems. For example, one major client had allowed separate divisions to purchase whatever computing equipment they wanted—Macintoshes and PCs, networked servers for some divisions and no network for others, etc. PB Technologies networked and integrated this company's computing resources over the course of a six-month period, saving the company hundreds of thousands of dollars in redundant data entry.

PB Technologies has experienced growth at or above the industry average for the past five years. The company is facing a number of serious problems. First, a number of major financial decisions have been deferred until the open position of Senior VP for Finance and CFO (chief financial officer) can be filled. Second, the company has experienced explosive growth, causing friction among divisions competing against each other for dominance and leading to a staggering variety of pricing incentives and marketing programs designed by each division.

You are a senior VP at PB Technologies. **Your task is to work with the other senior VPs to recommend to the CEO a Chief Financial Officer for PB Technologies from the attached list of three finalists.** Following is information from (1) their resumes and (2) from subordinates in the division of PB Technologies that you lead.

You should prepare by reviewing your information about the three candidates (about 10 minutes). Once you have done so (and before you discuss with the team), please mark which candidate you prefer on the corresponding line below:

_____Candidate A _____ Candidate B _____Candidate C

After your personal review, you will have 20 minutes to discuss the candidates with management team, after which everyone will vote for the final decision.

## RESUME INFORMATION

| | |
|---|---|
| Candidate A | • Currently: VP of Finance, PB Technologies<br>• Past Positions:<br>  ○ Analyst at Price Waterhouse<br>  ○ Various positions in the finance division of PB Technologies over the last 18 years<br>• Education: Executive MBA, 5 years ago |
| Candidate B | • Currently: VP of Finance, Technology Solutions Inc (PB Tech competitor)<br>• Past Positions:<br>  ○ Worked for two years in sales for IBM<br>  ○ Various managerial positions at Technology Solutions Inc<br>• Education: MBA in finance, 15 years ago |
| Candidate C | • Currently: Vice President of Accounting and Controller, PB Technologies<br>• Past Positions:<br>  ○ Securities and Exchange Commission Analyst<br>  ○ Various positions in accounting division at PB Technologies<br>• Education: MBA, 15 years ago; CPA, 19 years ago |

**VP OF OPERATIONS**

**<u>CONFIDENTIAL</u> INFORMATION FOR SENIOR VP OF OPERATIONS**

As Senior VP of Operations, you are especially concerned that the new CFO be able *to make the tough financial decisions* that will be necessary to keep this operation financially sound. You know that PB Technologies needs to make some massive financial investments in technology soon—you want to be sure that the company has the financial resources to make these investments.

The following is information that you have collected from sources within your own division of PB Technologies. <u>Your sources are CONFIDENTIAL, so this information must not be shown to the other members of the top management team. It can be discussed, however</u>.

Candidate A

- Personal attributes
    - Not an inspiring speaker
    - Good at attention to detail
- Other information known about this candidate
    - Got good reviews as chair of company dispute resolution committee
    - Likes to play chess

Candidate B

- Personal attributes
    - An excellent public speaker
    - Staff say candidate is a master at understanding and using organizational politics to candidate's advantage
    - Detail-oriented personality
- Other information known about this candidate
    - Was the volunteer CFO of a local homeless shelter for two years
    - Worked in London for two years in the finance division of the European operations of Technology Solutions, Inc.

Candidate C

- Personal attributes
    - Does not remember to recognize the contributions of others once projects are complete
    - Good insight into organizational politics
- Other information known about this candidate
    - Completed managerial leadership course offered by the company
    - Published extensively on how to improve internal audit practices